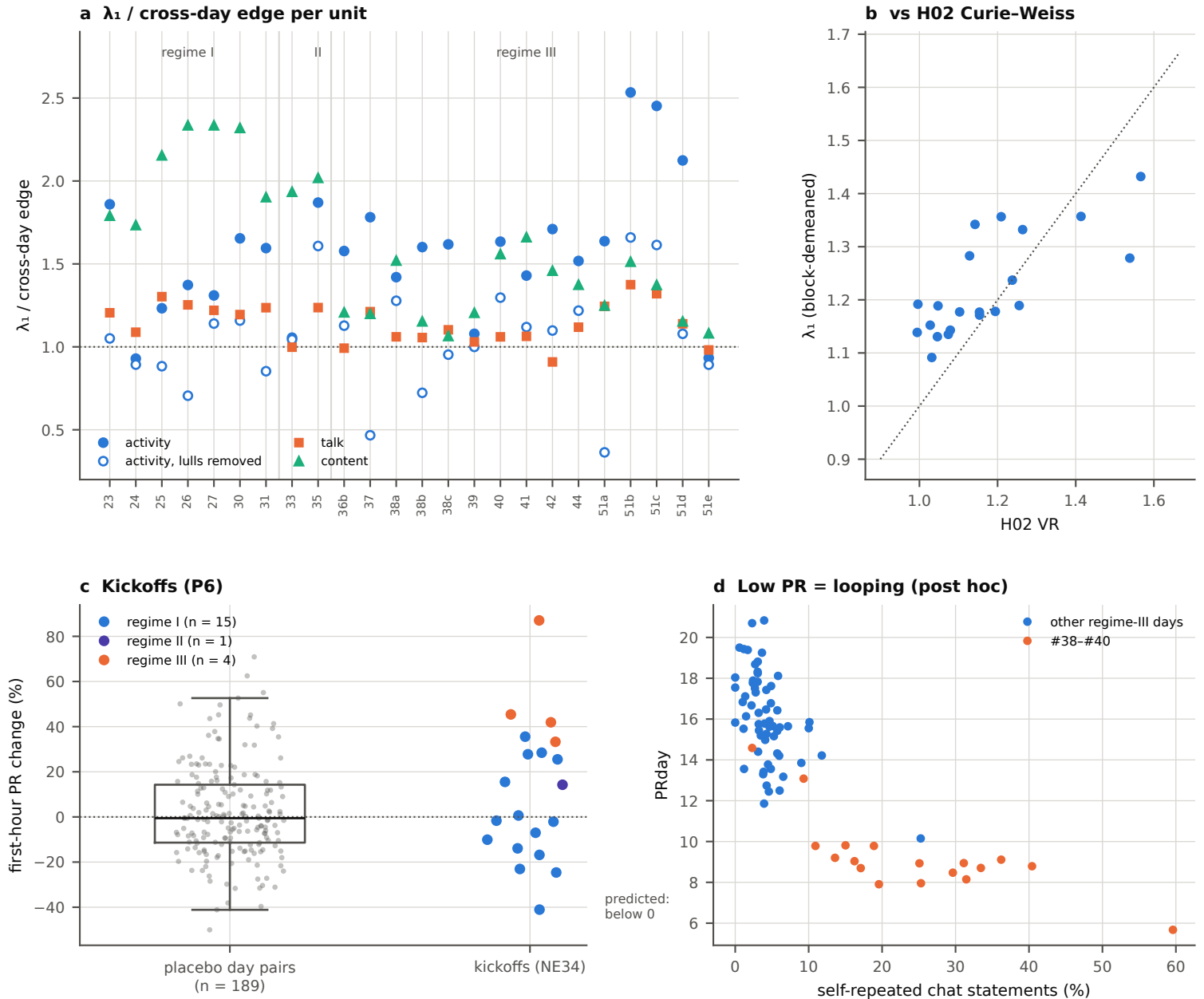


H12 · Groupthink is dimensional collapse — exploratory round 1 (non-holdout)

AI Village (AI Digest), goal periods split at step changes; 24 scored units ($N \geq 10$), 20 kickoff transitions. 2026-10-03.

Headline. The swarm has exactly one collective mode beyond random-matrix noise and the daily schedule — a uniform, Curie-Weiss-like 'market mode' — in activity (22/24 units), talk (20/24) and content (24/24). It is partly synchronized lulls. The dimensionality half fails in the predicted direction: kickoffs do not collapse the participation ratio; day 1 of a goal is higher-dimensional than later days (13/16, $p = 0.02$), and free weeks are not higher-dimensional than shared-objective weeks. The lowest-PR periods (#38-#40) are agents repeating themselves, not echoing each other.



Prediction	Rule	Observed	Verdict
P1 few activity modes	$k_{cd} \in 1-3$ in $\geq 2/3$; MP inflated	$k=1$ in 22/24, $k=0$ in 2; MP inflated in 7/24	core ✓, aux ✗
P1' beyond lulls	same after lull filter	$k=1$ in 14/24 (9/11 low-lull units)	✗
P2 Curie-Weiss market mode	uniform; III > I; lull drop $\geq 30\%$	uniform 22/22, VR/ λ_1 0.97; III > I; 11/24	2 of 3 (✗)
P3 talk + room mode	$k_{talk} \leq k_{act}$; room sep. $\geq 1/2$	22/24; 3/10 (8/10 sub-edge)	✗
P4 content modes	$k \geq 1$ in $\geq 1/2$; $C > I/F$	24/24; $C > I/F$ in I only	core ✓, aux ✗
P5 family mode	descriptive	lab separation in 10/24	-
P6 kickoff collapse (NE34)	median $\Delta < 0$, $\geq 2/3$ neg., $p < .05$	$\Delta +7\%$, 45% neg., $p = 0.86$	✗
P7 re-expansion	day 1 < later in $\geq 2/3$	3/16 (reversed, $p = .02$)	✗ (R4 wins)
P8 consensus weeks decline	slope < 0 in #19, #31, #40	#31 only	✗
P9 free > shared	regime I MW $p \leq .05$	$p = 0.58$	✗
P10 arms agree	$\rho < 0$ in I and III	$\rho = +0.36, +0.15$	✗